

What a friend we have in Jesus

Text: Joseph M. Scriven, 1855, alt.

Music: Charles C. Converse, 1868

CONVERSE 87.87 D

The musical score is written for a four-part setting (Soprano, Alto, Tenor, Bass) in the key of D major (two sharps) and 4/4 time. The melody is primarily in the Soprano part, with harmonization in the other parts. The score is divided into four systems, each with a key signature change indicated by a sharp sign on the F line of the Soprano staff. The lyrics are arranged in three columns, with the first column corresponding to the first system, the second to the second system, and the third to the third system. The fourth system contains the final line of the song. The lyrics are as follows:

1 What a friend we have in Je - sus, all our sins and griefs to bear!
2 Have we tri - als and temp - ta - tions? Is there trou - ble an - y - where?
3 Are we weak and heav - y la - den, 'cum - bered with a load of care?

What a priv - i - lege to car - ry ev - 'ry - thing to God in prayer!
We should nev - er be dis - cour - aged - take it to the Lord in prayer!
Pre - cious Sav - ior, still our ref - uge, take it to the Lord in prayer!

Oh, what peace we of - ten for - feit, oh, what need - less pain we bear,
Can we find a friend so faith - ful, who will all our sor - rows share?
Do thy friends de - spise, for - sake thee? Take it to the Lord in prayer!

all be - cause we do not car - ry ev - 'ry - thing to God in prayer!
Je - sus knows our ev - 'ry weak - ness - take it to the Lord in prayer!
Je - sus' arms will take and shield thee - thou wilt find a sol - ace there.